

VOLUNTEER & STAFF JOB DESCRIPTION MANUAL

Slugger Signature Event • Louisville, Kentucky

35 ROLE DESCRIPTIONS • 8 OPERATING TEAMS
Built for a large, multi-division VEX V5 Signature Event

People make great events possible.

This manual defines the purpose, responsibilities, preparation, skills, and coordination expectations for the volunteer and staff positions identified in the event staffing plan.

2026 EVENT OPERATIONS EDITION

How to Use This Manual

Each position description is designed to be usable for recruiting, assignment, pre-event briefing, and day-of-event reference. The descriptions expand the responsibilities in the staffing plan with current competition-operating practices and the needs of a large multi-division event.

When Global Robotics defines a volunteer role, the role's "What they do" definition in this manual is reproduced exactly as published. Slugger does not add to, subtract from, paraphrase, or transfer those responsibilities.

Eventwide volunteer standards

- Be student-centered. Volunteers support the competition and the students' experience; they do not perform team work, coach strategy during competition, or insert themselves into team decision-making.
- Be neutral and consistent. Apply the same process to every team and avoid preferential treatment, public criticism, or comments that could create the appearance of bias.
- Protect safety and access. Keep exits, aisles, cable paths, field perimeters, and work areas clear; report hazards immediately.
- Use verified information. When you do not know an answer, route the question to the correct lead rather than guessing.

- Protect confidential information. Judging notes, unpublished award results, private contact information, credentials, and internal event data must be handled carefully.
- Communicate early. Report delays, missing teams, technology failures, supply shortages, staffing gaps, and safety issues before they become eventwide problems.
- Arrive ready. Be on time, check in, attend required training, wear the assigned credential/shirt, and use closed-toe shoes for field, setup, teardown, or technical work.

Leadership and escalation

Questions should move to the person who owns the decision. Game rulings go to the Head Referee; robot legality goes to inspection leadership; judging decisions stay within the judging team; technical failures go to technical leadership; and safety or venue concerns go to the Safety / Logistics Lead. Division Managers coordinate operations but do not replace the authority of specialized officials.

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OPERATING TEAM	POSITIONS
Technical Operations	Technical Operations Lead • Tournament Manager Lead • A/V Lead • Stream Operators (Camera) • IT Support • Smart Field Control Support • Technology Setup • Technology Breakdown
Competition Field Operations	Division Manager • Senior Head Referee • Head Referee • Main Field Scorekeepers • Field Resetters • Queuers • Skills Scorekeepers • Skills Queueing • Emcee
Robot Inspection Team	Robot Inspection Lead • Head Robot Inspector • Robot Inspectors • Field Inspection Support • Pit Administrators
Judging Team	Judge Advisor / Lead • Judge Advisor • Notebook Pre-Judging • Judges
Team Support/Communication	Communications Lead • Signage • Check-In Staff • Information Desk Volunteers
Awards & Ceremonies	Awards / Ceremony Lead • Award Ceremony Support
Hospitality	Hospitality Lead • Volunteer Hospitality Team • Team Hospitality Team
Safety & Logistics	Safety / Logistics Lead • Venue Setup Crew • Teardown Crew

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

Keeps the technology behind the tournament reliable, recoverable, and invisible to the student experience. These roles protect scoring, field control, connectivity, audio/visual presentation, and data integrity.

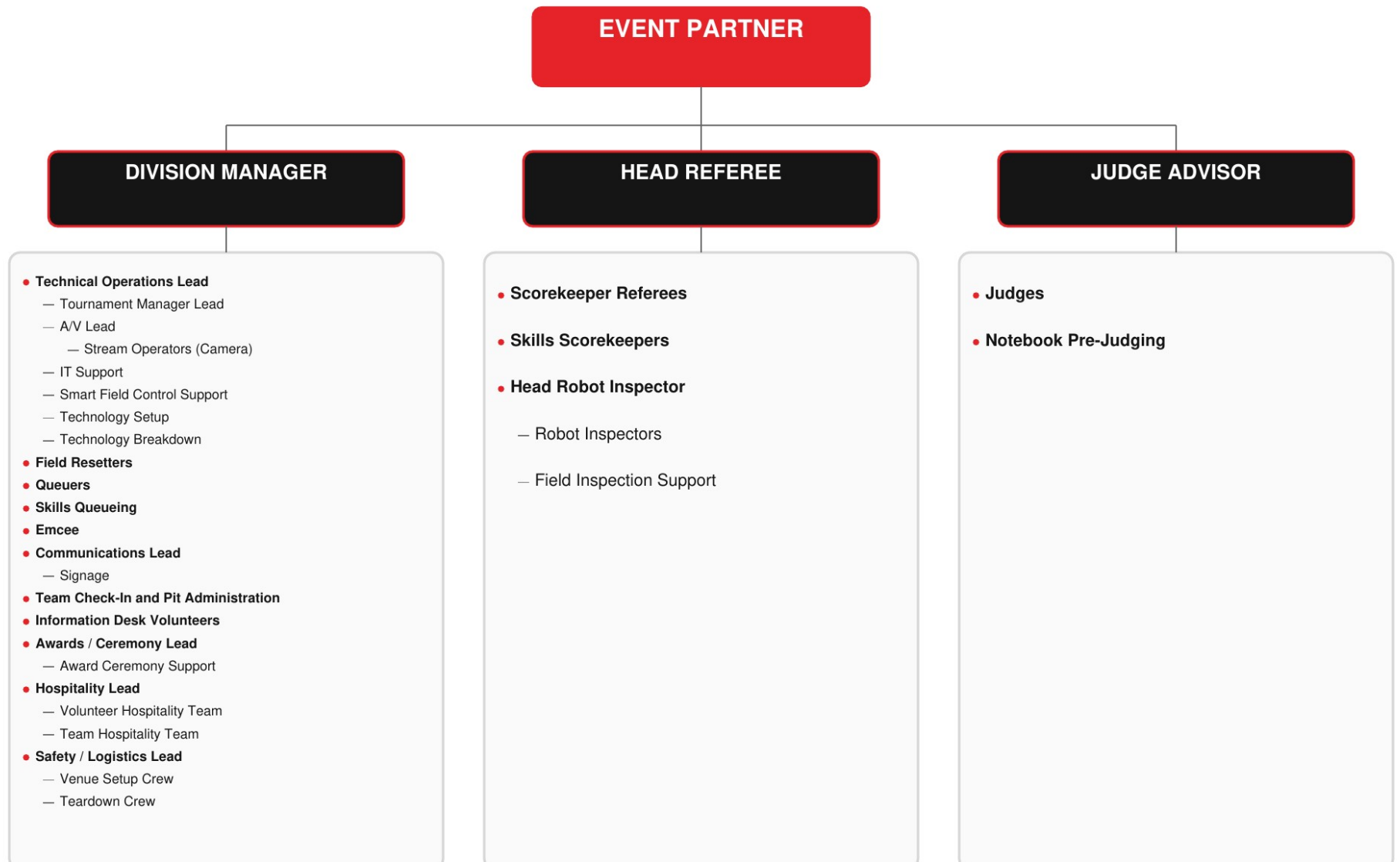
9 POSITIONS

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow



ORGANIZATIONAL CHART

Slugger Signature Event | Event Operations



Technical Operations Lead

POSITION SUMMARY Owns the event technology plan from load-in through shutdown and serves as the primary point of contact for all competition technology, network, field-control, audio/visual, display, and Tournament Manager issues.

Primary Responsibilities

- Create and maintain the eventwide technology plan, including equipment assignments, network layout, field-control connectivity, displays, scoring computers, printers, streaming equipment, and backup hardware.
- Lead technology setup and testing before teams arrive; verify that each division, skills area, judging support area, and public display has the required connectivity and power.
- Coordinate the Tournament Manager Lead, A/V Lead, IT Support, field-control support, and setup/breakdown teams so ownership is clear and issues are routed quickly.
- Establish a troubleshooting and escalation process for match-critical failures, including spare-device readiness and a method for documenting recurring issues.
- Confirm software versions, event files, backups, device naming, time synchronization, and access credentials are controlled and available to authorized staff.
- Monitor event operations and prioritize technical work that protects match flow, score integrity, audience information, and livestream continuity.
- Lead the orderly shutdown, data backup, equipment inventory, cable recovery, and handoff at the end of the event.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong understanding of competition technology and event networking
- Calm troubleshooting under time pressure
- Ability to coordinate multiple technical teams
- Clear communication with nontechnical staff

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Review the venue technology and power plan before load-in.
- Confirm spares, adapters, switches, cables, chargers, and backup computers are labeled and tested.
- Run a full end-to-end test of field control, scoring, audience displays, and streaming before competition begins.

Coordinates With

Event Director, Division Managers, Tournament Manager Lead, A/V Lead, IT Support, field-control support, venue technology staff

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role’s authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

Tournament Manager Lead

What they do

Runs the event software, enters match results, manages the match schedule and displays, and generates rankings and alliance selection. This role works beside you for most of the day.

Requirements

None. Best filled by someone comfortable with software who can practice before event day.

A/V Lead

POSITION SUMMARY Leads event audio, audience displays, video presentation, lighting interfaces, and livestream production so teams and spectators receive a polished, reliable event experience.

Primary Responsibilities

- Develop the audio/visual signal plan for competition areas, ceremonies, pit/public spaces, and livestream destinations.
- Configure and test microphones, mixers, speakers, cameras, video switching, confidence monitors, projectors/LED displays, playback sources, and presentation computers.
- Coordinate with Tournament Manager operators so match data, timers, rankings, brackets, and results appear on the correct displays at the correct times.
- Maintain clear communication with Emcees and ceremony leads regarding microphones, music, walk-up cues, award presentations, and announcements.
- Supervise stream operators and establish camera assignments, shot priorities, switching expectations, and contingency plans.
- Troubleshoot A/V failures rapidly without interfering with field operations or match officials.
- Protect event recordings, stream credentials, and media equipment through controlled access and organized shutdown.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Live-event A/V experience
- Audio gain and feedback management
- Video switching and display routing
- Strong cueing and team communication

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Complete a sound check and display test in every competition area.
- Confirm backup microphones, cables, adapters, batteries, and playback options.
- Run a production rehearsal for opening, match flow, alliance selection, and awards.

Coordinates With

Technical Operations Lead, Tournament Manager Lead, Emcees, Stream Operators, Awards / Ceremony Lead, venue A/V staff

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

Stream Operators (Camera)

POSITION SUMMARY Capture and present clear, engaging live video of competition matches and event activity while supporting the A/V Lead and maintaining professional coverage.

Primary Responsibilities

- Operate assigned cameras, tripods, capture devices, or switching positions according to the event production plan.
- Keep active match play framed clearly, prioritizing the field and student competition rather than spectators or unrelated activity.
- Follow switching and camera-direction cues from the A/V Lead and maintain consistent shot composition, focus, exposure, and movement.
- Help identify compelling but non-disruptive event visuals between matches, including field reset, team introductions, awards, and crowd atmosphere.
- Avoid recording private judging conversations, sensitive information, or restricted operational areas unless specifically authorized.
- Monitor camera power, media, cables, and network connectivity; report failures immediately.
- Keep camera positions and cables safe, neat, and clear of team traffic and emergency routes.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Basic camera operation and visual composition
- Ability to follow live production cues
- Awareness of cable and crowd safety
- Professional judgment around students and private areas

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Learn the camera position and shot expectations before doors open.
- Verify battery/power, focus, framing, and connection to the production system.
- Practice match starts, autonomous period coverage, endgame coverage, and awards shots.

Coordinates With

A/V Lead, other Stream Operators, Emcees, Division Managers

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

IT Support

POSITION SUMMARY Provides rapid on-site support for the event network, computers, printers, tablets, displays, and related systems, with priority given to match-critical technology.

Primary Responsibilities

- Monitor wired and wireless network health in competition, scoring, pit, and staff areas.
- Troubleshoot computers, tablets, printers, display endpoints, switches, access points, adapters, and peripheral devices used for event operations.
- Support Tournament Manager operators without making unapproved changes to official scoring or event data.
- Maintain an organized inventory of spare devices, chargers, cables, adapters, and replacement peripherals.
- Segment and secure event operations from unnecessary guest traffic where the venue/network design permits.
- Document major incidents and their resolution so repeated failures can be addressed consistently.
- Escalate field-control or A/V-specific problems to the appropriate specialist rather than creating conflicting changes.

Skills & Preparation**BEST FIT / SKILLS**

- Practical network and endpoint troubleshooting
- Windows and common event-device support
- Ability to prioritize production-impacting incidents
- Strong documentation and communication habits

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Validate network addressing, switch ports, wireless coverage, and internet dependencies.
- Pre-stage spare laptops/tablets and required software.
- Know which systems are match-critical and who has authority to approve changes.

Coordinates With

Technical Operations Lead, Tournament Manager Lead, A/V Lead, field-control support, venue IT

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

Smart Field Control Support

POSITION SUMMARY Maintains competition field-control electronics and robot-to-field connectivity, helping divisions recover quickly from hardware, cabling, or connection problems.

Primary Responsibilities

- Inspect and test field-control hardware, field monitors, control cabling, network connections, and related electronics before competition.
- Remain available during matches for rapid diagnosis of field-side connectivity or control problems when requested by the Division Manager, Head Referee, or Tournament Manager operator.
- Use controlled troubleshooting steps and avoid unnecessary configuration changes during active competition.
- Maintain labeled spare control components, cables, adapters, power supplies, and known-good replacement hardware.
- Help distinguish field-side failures from robot-side issues so teams receive accurate direction without delaying the event.
- Coordinate any field-control replacement or restart with the match officials and Tournament Manager operator before action is taken.
- Document recurring failures and ensure repaired or suspect components are clearly identified.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Hands-on experience with VEX field-control systems
- Structured electrical/connectivity troubleshooting
- Ability to work safely around active competition fields
- Clear communication under time pressure

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Build and test every field-control chain before teams arrive.
- Label spares and document the standard configuration for each field.
- Review escalation procedures and restart/replacement authority with division staff.

Coordinates With

Technical Operations Lead, Division Managers, Head Referees, Tournament Manager Lead, IT Support

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

Technology Setup

POSITION SUMMARY Installs, labels, connects, and tests the event technology infrastructure before competition so each area is ready for operational verification.

Primary Responsibilities

- Run and secure network, audio, video, field-control, display, and power cabling according to the event plan.
- Place and connect scoring computers, monitors, displays, printers, switches, access points, field-control devices, and A/V equipment as assigned.
- Use cable covers, ties, labels, and routing methods that protect equipment and keep walkways clear.
- Assist technical leads with device naming, endpoint verification, display routing, and test-match preparation.
- Report missing, damaged, or incompatible components immediately rather than improvising unsafe or undocumented solutions.
- Complete a physical sweep after setup to confirm power strips, cables, and equipment are stable and protected from team traffic.
- Remain available for final adjustments until the Technical Operations Lead releases the setup crew.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Comfort with cables and basic event technology
- Ability to follow diagrams and labeling standards
- Safe lifting and ladder awareness where applicable
- Teamwork and attention to detail

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Wear closed-toe shoes and be prepared for lifting, kneeling, and extended walking.
- Review the technology floor plan and labeling convention.
- Do not power or reconfigure equipment until the appropriate lead authorizes it.

Coordinates With

Technical Operations Lead, A/V Lead, IT Support, field-control support, venue staff

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TECHNICAL OPERATIONS

Technology Breakdown

POSITION SUMMARY Safely disconnects, inventories, packs, and returns event technology after competition while protecting equipment and preserving a clean handoff.

Primary Responsibilities

- Disconnect technology only after the responsible lead confirms systems and official event data are safely shut down.

- Recover network, audio, video, field-control, and power cabling without damaging connectors, flooring, or venue infrastructure.
- Pack devices in labeled cases and keep accessories with their assigned systems.
- Separate damaged or suspect equipment for follow-up rather than returning it to the ready-to-use inventory.
- Assist with equipment counts and identify missing items before cases leave the venue.
- Remove temporary tape, cable protection, labels, and technical staging materials as directed.
- Leave technology areas clean and report any venue or equipment damage to the Technical Operations Lead.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Organized equipment handling
- Safe lifting and cable recovery
- Ability to follow packing/inventory procedures
- Careful attention at the end of a long event

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Know which cases and storage locations belong to each technical system.
- Wait for formal shutdown authorization before disconnecting match-critical equipment.
- Use two-person lifting for heavy or awkward equipment.

Coordinates With

Technical Operations Lead, A/V Lead, IT Support, field-control support, venue teardown crew

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

COMPETITION FIELD OPERATIONS

Runs the live competition floor. These roles protect fair play, accurate scoring, safe fields, efficient queueing, and a consistent match rhythm across divisions.

9 POSITIONS

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

COMPETITION FIELD OPERATIONS

Division Manager

POSITION SUMMARY Serves as the operational leader for an assigned competition division, coordinating people, schedule, technology, match flow, and issue escalation so the division runs consistently and on time.

Primary Responsibilities

- Lead the division's daily opening, readiness check, staff briefing, and communication plan.
- Coordinate Head Referees, scorekeepers, queuers, field resetters, Tournament Manager staff, Emcees, field technology, and A/V support.
- Monitor match cycle time and remove operational bottlenecks while protecting correct scoring, safe field access, and fair competition.
- Keep queuing, field reset, scoring, display, and match-start activities synchronized across multiple competition fields.
- Escalate unresolved technical, safety, staffing, schedule, or venue issues to the appropriate eventwide lead.
- Plan volunteer rotations and breaks so critical field positions remain continuously staffed.
- Coordinate transitions into alliance selection, elimination matches, division awards, and end-of-day shutdown.
- Act as the primary operational point of contact for the division without replacing the Head Referee's authority over game rulings.

Skills & Preparation**BEST FIT / SKILLS**

- Strong live-event leadership
- Excellent situational awareness
- Ability to solve problems without disrupting officials
- Clear radio and face-to-face communication

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Review the division layout, staffing plan, schedule, radio channels, and escalation tree.
- Conduct a pre-opening walkthrough with the Head Referee and Tournament Manager

Lead.

- Confirm queuing, field reset, scoring, technology, and A/V are ready before the first match.

Coordinates With

Event Director, Technical Operations Lead, Head Referees, Tournament Manager Lead, Emcees, field crews, Safety / Logistics Lead

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

COMPETITION FIELD OPERATIONS

Senior Head Referee

POSITION SUMMARY Provides eventwide rules leadership and referee coordination, promoting consistent game interpretation across divisions and serving as the primary rules escalation resource for Head Referees.

Primary Responsibilities

- Maintain current-season mastery of the game manual, official updates, Q&A clarifications, and referee guidance.
- Lead the pre-event referee briefing and establish consistent standards for scoring, penalties, match communication, and team interactions.
- Support division Head Referees with difficult interpretations and help ensure comparable situations are handled consistently across the event.
- Coordinate with inspection leadership when robot legality or safety questions overlap with game rules.
- Observe event trends and proactively brief officials when a recurring situation needs a consistent approach.
- Support Head Referees in de-escalating disputes and keeping discussions factual, respectful, and student-centered.
- Serve as the designated eventwide rules escalation point while respecting the assigned Head Referee's responsibility for rulings on the matches they oversee.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Expert current-season rules knowledge
- Extensive Head Referee experience
- Impartial decision-making and conflict de-escalation

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Complete all current-season referee certification and updates applicable to the event.
- Review recent official rule changes and

- Ability to coach and align other officials

- common edge cases with all Head Referees.
- Agree on escalation and communication procedures before practice begins.

Coordinates With

Event Director, Division Managers, Head Referees, Head Robot Inspector, Tournament Manager Lead

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

COMPETITION FIELD OPERATIONS

Head Referee

What they do

Rules on match play, makes final scoring decisions, and handles rules questions from teams. The Head Referee is the final authority on the field.

Requirements

- 20 or older (for the VEX V5 Robotics Competition)
- Completed Head Referee Certification for the current season's game.

Scorekeeper Referees

What they do

Scores matches alongside the Head Referee, tracks scoring elements during play, and confirms results before they are entered.

Requirements

- 15 or older
- Certification is recommended but not required.

Field Resetters

What they do

Resets fields between matches, positions game elements correctly, and confirms the field is ready before each match starts.

Requirements

None. Easy to teach on event morning, and a good fit for new volunteers or students who are not competing.

Queuers

What they do

Gets the right teams to the right field at the right time, working a match or two ahead of the current one. Queuing is the difference between a schedule that holds and one that slips.

Sluggie believes this is the most important role in the tournament.

Requirements

Be an organized person.

Skills Scorekeepers

POSITION SUMMARY Scores Skills matches alongside the Head Referee, tracks scoring elements during play, and confirms results before they are entered.

Primary Responsibilities

- Score Skills matches alongside the Head Referee.
- Track scoring elements during play.
- Confirm results before they are entered.

Requirements

REQUIREMENTS

- Age 15 or older.
- Certification recommended, not required.

AUTHORITY

Global Robotics role definition controls.
Source: library.globalrobotics.org

Coordinates With

Head Referee, Skills Queueing, Tournament Manager Lead, Division Manager

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

COMPETITION FIELD OPERATIONS

Skills Queueing

POSITION SUMMARY Manages the Robot Skills waiting line, verifies team readiness, and feeds teams to the skills field in a fair and efficient sequence.

Primary Responsibilities

- Organize teams waiting for skills attempts and communicate the current queue process clearly.
- Confirm the team number and intended skills match type before sending a team to the field.
- Keep the on-deck team ready so the next attempt can begin promptly after reset.
- Prevent crowding around the skills field and keep access routes open.
- Coordinate any published limits, closing times, or end-of-line procedures with event leadership.
- Communicate temporary field closures or delays to waiting teams and help preserve order when demand is high.
- Alert the Skills Scorekeeper or Division Manager to unusual queue issues rather than creating ad hoc exceptions.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Fair and consistent queue management
- Clear communication with students and coaches
- Strong organization
- Ability to stay composed during high demand

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Learn the event's skills operating hours and queue policy.
- Understand where teams enter, wait, stage, and exit.
- Coordinate opening and closing procedures with the Skills Scorekeeper.

Coordinates With

Skills Scorekeepers, Division Manager, Team Check-In and Pit Administration, Head Referee

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

COMPETITION FIELD OPERATIONS

Emcee

What they do

Announces matches, keeps teams and spectators oriented on what is happening and what comes next, and runs the microphone through the awards ceremony.

Requirements

If you have to get instruction on what to do from this manual, you're probably not the right person.

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

ROBOT INSPECTION TEAM

POSITION SUMMARY Leads pit and inspection operations, ensuring teams can check in, complete robot inspection, receive accurate assistance, and move through the pit area safely and efficiently.

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong event organization
- Familiarity with V5 inspection and pit operations
- Ability to coordinate multiple volunteer functions
- Clear, calm communication with teams

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Design the inspection and pit traffic flow before teams arrive.
- Confirm inspection tools, sizing devices, checklists, tables, and signage are ready.
- Brief inspection and pit staff on escalation procedures and opening priorities.

Head Robot Inspector

POSITION SUMMARY Oversees robot inspection and serves as the inspection team's primary rules resource, ensuring robots are checked consistently for legality, dimensions, construction requirements, and safety.

Primary Responsibilities

- Train and supervise Robot Inspectors on the current inspection checklist and consistent interpretation of robot requirements.
- Handle inspection questions that are unclear or disputed and consult the appropriate Head Referee when a game-rule interpretation is needed.
- Monitor inspection throughput and assign inspectors to keep teams moving efficiently.
- Ensure robots that do not pass receive a clear explanation of what must be corrected before reinspection.
- Coordinate reinspection when a robot changes substantially or when field staff identify a potential compliance issue.
- Maintain a professional, educational tone: inspectors verify compliance but do not redesign or build the robot for students.
- Report persistent safety or legality concerns to the Robot Inspection Lead and field leadership.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong current-season robot rules knowledge
- Consistency and attention to detail
- Ability to explain requirements to students
- Leadership of an inspection team

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Review the current inspection checklist, legal-parts guidance, and recent rule updates.
- Calibrate sizing tools and confirm inspection stations are complete.
- Brief inspectors on common issues and the process for escalating uncertain calls.

Coordinates With

Robot Inspection Lead, Robot Inspectors, Senior Head Referee, Head Referees, Field Inspection Support

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

ROBOT INSPECTION TEAM

Robot Inspectors

What they do

Checks each robot against the inspection checklist before the team competes, confirming size, components, and rules compliance. Re-inspects robots that change during the day.

Requirements

None.

Field Inspection Support

POSITION SUMMARY Provides on-event compliance support by observing robots in competition and assisting with targeted reinspections when a robot's configuration, safety, or legality may have changed after initial inspection.

Primary Responsibilities

- Observe robots and field-side conditions for visible changes or concerns that may warrant reinspection.
- Respond to requests from Head Referees, the Head Robot Inspector, or Division Managers for a focused compliance check.
- Use the official inspection criteria and avoid making informal field-side legality rulings outside the inspection process.
- Direct teams to the inspection area when a full reinspection is required.
- Help distinguish normal repairs from changes that materially affect inspection status.
- Communicate findings promptly to the Head Robot Inspector and requesting official.
- Keep interactions respectful and minimally disruptive to teams preparing for matches.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong robot inspection knowledge
- Good observation and discretion
- Ability to communicate without escalating tension
- Comfort moving between pits and competition fields

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Review common mid-event robot changes that can trigger reinspection.
- Agree on a clear request/escalation process with Head Referees and the Head Robot Inspector.
- Carry only the approved tools/forms needed for targeted checks.

Coordinates With

Head Robot Inspector, Head Referees, Division Managers, Robot Inspection Lead

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

ROBOT INSPECTION TEAM

POSITION SUMMARY Performs the Team Check-In and Pit Administration function: checks teams in, confirms rosters and paperwork, provides pit assignments, directs teams to inspection, and staffs the pit area for the rest of the day.

REQUIREMENTS

- No formal requirement.

AUTHORITY

Global Robotics role definition controls.
Source: library.globalrobotics.org

JUDGING TEAM

Evaluates student work through a consistent, confidential, evidence-based process. These roles focus on student interviews, Engineering Notebooks, rubrics, deliberation, and award integrity.

4 POSITIONS

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

JUDGING TEAM

Judge Advisor

What they do

Manages the judging process, facilitates award deliberations, and submits final award winners to you. Also assists you with Code of Conduct and Student-Centered Policy concerns.

Requirements

- 21 or older
- Completed the current season's official Judge Certification (coming soon)
- No or minimal conflicts of interest with attending teams
- Not part of a competing team

Notebook Pre-Judging

POSITION SUMMARY Reviews assigned Engineering Notebooks before or early in the event using the current rubric, captures evidence that will help interview teams focus their questions, and identifies strong notebook candidates for further consideration.

Primary Responsibilities

- Review each assigned Engineering Notebook using the official current-season rubric rather than personal preferences for format or appearance.
- Look for evidence of problem definition, development of solutions, testing, documented decisions, optimization, reflection, and iteration.
- Record concise, evidence-based notes that interview Judges can use to ask better questions.
- Apply consistent scoring standards across the assigned notebook set and discuss calibration questions with the Judge Advisor.
- Protect notebook contents, scores, rankings, and reviewer notes as confidential judging information.

- Flag incomplete, inaccessible, or unusual submissions for the Judge Advisor instead of creating independent exceptions.
- Complete assigned reviews within the judging schedule so results are available before interviews and deliberation.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Careful reading and analytical judgment
- Ability to use a rubric consistently
- Concise note-taking
- Strong confidentiality

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Read the current Engineering Notebook rubric and judging guidance before reviewing teams.
- Participate in a short scoring calibration with the Judge Advisor.
- Use the event's approved method for accessing and securing digital or physical notebooks.

Coordinates With

Judge Advisor, Judge Advisor, interview Judges

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

JUDGING TEAM

Judges

What they do

Interviews teams, reviews Engineering Notebooks, and evaluates teams against the award criteria.

Requirements

- Certification is recommended but not required.
- 20 or older for the VEX V5 Robotics Competition, and not part of a competing VEX V5 Robotics Competition team.

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

TEAM SUPPORT/COMMUNICATION

Communications Lead

POSITION SUMMARY Owns public-facing event communication across social media, website updates, email, and approved on-site messaging so teams, families, volunteers, and partners receive accurate information.

Primary Responsibilities

- Maintain a communication calendar for pre-event reminders, travel information, schedules, volunteer updates, sponsor recognition, and event-day messages.
- Publish only verified schedule, venue, competition, and policy information; confirm operational changes with event leadership before posting.
- Coordinate timely event-day social coverage while avoiding interference with competition, judging, safety, or private team spaces.
- Maintain consistent event branding, tone, logos, sponsor recognition, and naming across channels.
- Prepare reusable message templates for weather, delays, schedule changes, lost items, emergency communication, and post-event follow-up.
- Coordinate photography/video use with event media policies and respect students or attendees who cannot be featured.
- Archive key communications, approved graphics, and final event information for future planning.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong writing and editing
- Social media and website publishing
- Fast fact-checking under deadline
- Brand consistency and professional judgment

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Collect approved logos, sponsor names, schedules, venue information, and contact lists.
- Confirm who can authorize urgent or schedule-sensitive messages.
- Prepare event-day templates and a content capture plan before doors open.

Coordinates With

Event Director, Division Managers, A/V Lead, Signage, Information Desk, sponsor/partner contacts

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TEAM SUPPORT/COMMUNICATION

Signage

POSITION SUMMARY Plans, produces, places, and maintains event signage so teams and spectators can quickly navigate the venue and understand key schedules, areas, and instructions.

Primary Responsibilities

- Create a signage inventory covering entrances, check-in, pits, inspection, divisions, skills, judging, restrooms, hospitality, emergency routes, and restricted areas.
- Use consistent branding, readable type, high contrast, and clear directional language.
- Place signs where decisions are made—not only at destinations—and verify they are visible from normal traffic paths.
- Coordinate temporary schedule, room, or route changes and replace outdated signs promptly.
- Protect venue walls and finishes by using only approved mounting methods.
- Perform periodic walkthroughs to correct fallen, blocked, confusing, or missing signs.
- Remove all event signage during teardown and return reusable pieces to storage.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong visual organization
- Attention to venue traffic flow
- Basic print/production skills
- Ability to respond quickly to changes

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Walk the venue using the perspective of a first-time team.
- Prepare a master sign list, placement map, mounting supplies, and extras.
- Confirm room names and event terminology before printing.

Coordinates With

Communications Lead, Safety / Logistics Lead, Team Check-In and Pit Administration, Robot Inspection Lead, venue staff

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

TEAM SUPPORT/COMMUNICATION

Team Check-In and Pit Administration

What they do

Checks teams in, confirms rosters and paperwork, hands out pit assignments, and points teams toward inspection. Staffs the pit area for the rest of the day.

Requirements

None.

Information Desk Volunteers

POSITION SUMMARY Provide a reliable central help point for teams, families, volunteers, and spectators, answering routine questions and routing specialized issues to the correct staff member.

Primary Responsibilities

- Answer common questions about schedules, room locations, parking, concessions, restrooms, awards, skills, pits, and public event services.
- Use current event information and avoid guessing; verify uncertain answers before directing attendees.
- Maintain maps, schedules, contact lists, lost-and-found records, and approved announcements at the desk.
- Route game-rule questions to referees, robot-rule questions to inspection, judging questions to judging leadership, and safety issues to the appropriate lead.
- Assist with accessibility directions and general venue navigation.
- Capture recurring questions so signage or communications can be improved during the event.
- Remain welcoming and calm during schedule changes, delays, or high-traffic periods.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Friendly communication
- Strong knowledge of the event layout
- Good judgment about when to escalate
- Organization and patience

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Study the venue map, event agenda, major contacts, and public policies.
- Keep updated printed/digital references available.
- Confirm how lost-and-found, accessibility requests, and urgent messages are handled.

Coordinates With

Communications Lead, Signage, Team Check-In and Pit Administration, Team Check-In and Pit Administration, Safety / Logistics Lead

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

AWARDS & CEREMONIES

Turns results and recognition into a polished celebration. These roles protect award accuracy, ceremony timing, stage flow, and the student moment.

2 POSITIONS

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

AWARDS & CEREMONIES

Awards / Ceremony Lead

POSITION SUMMARY Plans and executes opening, recognition, and closing ceremonies while protecting the accuracy, order, appearance, and timing of trophies, certificates, scripts, and award presentations.

Primary Responsibilities

- Build the ceremony run-of-show, stage layout, award order, presenter assignments, walk-up paths, scripts, music cues, and timing.
- Inventory trophies, banners, certificates, medals, or other award materials and verify names/labels before presentation.
- Receive the final approved award-recipient list through the designated confidential handoff and keep it secure until announcement.
- Coordinate with Tournament Manager staff, judging leadership, Emcees, A/V, photography, and stage support.
- Rehearse major transitions, including opening remarks, sponsor recognition, division awards, championship awards, and event close.
- Ensure winners move safely and efficiently on and off the presentation area and that awards are handed to the correct team.
- Reconcile unclaimed awards and ceremony materials after the event.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Live ceremony/stage management
- Meticulous attention to names and award order
- Strong cueing and coordination
- Ability to work with confidential results

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Prepare a printed run-of-show and duplicate award list for authorized staff.
- Physically lay out awards in presentation order before the ceremony.
- Complete a microphone, music, lighting, and stage-flow rehearsal.

Coordinates With

Event Director, Judge Advisor, Tournament Manager Lead, A/V Lead, Emcees, Award Ceremony Support

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

AWARDS & CEREMONIES

Award Ceremony Support

POSITION SUMMARY Supports stage operations during ceremonies by staging awards and presenters, cueing teams, managing traffic, and assisting with smooth, professional presentations.

Primary Responsibilities

- Arrange trophies, certificates, banners, and presentation materials in the exact run-of-show order.
- Stage presenters and teams before they are called, confirming team numbers and correct award materials.
- Cue entrances, exits, photos, and handoffs according to the Ceremony Lead's direction.
- Keep backstage or staging areas clear, quiet, and organized.
- Assist with microphones, podium materials, award table replenishment, and last-minute script or order changes.
- Help teams exit the stage safely and efficiently so the ceremony maintains momentum.
- Collect unused materials and report discrepancies immediately after the ceremony.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong organization
- Ability to follow live cues
- Friendly team interaction
- Comfort working quickly behind the scenes

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Review the full ceremony order and stage traffic plan.
- Know where every award and presenter will be staged.
- Participate in the pre-ceremony walkthrough and cue rehearsal.

Coordinates With

Awards / Ceremony Lead, Emcees, A/V Lead, photographers, presenters

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

HOSPITALITY

Supports the people who make the event possible. These roles keep volunteers and teams welcomed, fed, hydrated, informed, and ready for long competition days.

3 POSITIONS

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

HOSPITALITY

Hospitality Lead

POSITION SUMMARY Leads volunteer and team hospitality planning, ensuring food, beverages, rest areas, information, and service support are organized, stocked, and delivered reliably throughout the event.

Primary Responsibilities

- Create the hospitality plan for volunteer meals, snacks, beverages, serving times, storage, cleanup, and dietary accommodations where feasible.
- Coordinate the Volunteer Hospitality Team and Team Hospitality Team, including staffing, supplies, and service schedules.
- Maintain clean, inviting hospitality spaces without interfering with competition or restricted areas.
- Monitor inventory and replenish high-use items before shortages affect volunteers or teams.
- Coordinate delivery access, vendor timing, waste removal, and food-safe handling practices.
- Ensure key volunteers with fixed field assignments receive practical meal/break support.
- Communicate hospitality locations and hours clearly to event staff and teams.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Strong logistics and service mindset
- Food-service organization
- Budget and inventory awareness
- Ability to coordinate volunteers and vendors

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Confirm headcounts, dietary information, vendor orders, delivery windows, serving supplies, and refrigeration needs.
- Create a restocking and cleanup schedule.
- Identify how field-bound volunteers will receive meals without leaving critical positions uncovered.

Coordinates With

Event Director, Volunteer Hospitality Team, Team Hospitality Team, Division Managers, Safety / Logistics Lead, venue catering

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

HOSPITALITY

Volunteer Hospitality Team

What they do

Runs concessions if you offer them, and keeps your volunteers fed and hydrated through the day.

Requirements

None.

Team Hospitality Team

POSITION SUMMARY Supports competing teams and their accompanying adults with practical event information, basic hospitality needs, and a welcoming presence throughout the venue.

Primary Responsibilities

- Help teams locate event services, food options, water, rest areas, venue amenities, and other public resources.
- Coordinate any team-facing hospitality stations, welcome items, or approved refreshments.
- Provide verified information and route competition, judging, inspection, or rules questions to the correct officials.
- Watch for teams that appear lost or need accessibility/navigation assistance and help them reach the correct area.
- Keep team hospitality areas clean, stocked, and orderly.
- Escalate medical, safety, or welfare concerns immediately rather than attempting to handle them independently.
- Support a positive, welcoming experience for visiting teams from outside the region.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Warm customer service
- Good knowledge of venue resources
- Clear communication
- Cultural awareness and patience

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Learn the venue map, nearby food options, event services, and public schedule.
- Know where medical, safety, information, and competition leads are located.
- Review any welcome items or sponsor-provided hospitality details.

Coordinates With

Hospitality Lead, Information Desk, Team Check-In and Pit Administration, Communications Lead, Safety / Logistics Lead

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

SAFETY & LOGISTICS

Builds and protects the physical event environment. These roles coordinate safe setup, venue flow, emergency response, incident documentation, and teardown.

3 POSITIONS

Operational focus: accuracy • communication • student experience • event flow

SAFETY & LOGISTICS

Safety / Logistics Lead

POSITION SUMMARY Leads venue safety and event logistics, coordinating emergency response, incident documentation, access routes, physical setup, and rapid resolution of facility or operational hazards.

Primary Responsibilities

- Develop and communicate the event safety and emergency response plan, including medical response, evacuation, severe weather, lost child/vulnerable person, and incident escalation procedures.
- Maintain emergency exits, fire lanes, accessible routes, field perimeters, queue lanes, and high-traffic areas free of obstructions.
- Coordinate setup and teardown logistics with venue staff, including loading access, carts, storage, power distribution, tables, barriers, and signage.
- Respond to reported hazards and incidents, document material events, and notify venue/security/medical resources as appropriate.
- Monitor cable protection, temporary power, trip hazards, crowd flow, and safe equipment placement throughout the event.
- Coordinate with division and pit leaders when safety concerns require a temporary operational pause or area restriction.
- Ensure incident documentation is factual, timely, and retained according to the event's process.

Skills & Preparation**BEST FIT / SKILLS**

- Event safety and logistics experience
- Calm emergency decision-making
- Strong venue coordination
- Clear documentation and radio communication

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Walk the venue with facility staff and confirm emergency exits, first-aid/AED locations, shelter areas, and emergency contacts.
- Review load-in/load-out plans, power

- distribution, cable routing, and crowd flow.
- Brief key leads on reporting procedures and who can call for venue/security/medical assistance.

Coordinates With

Event Director, venue management/security, Division Managers, Robot Inspection Lead, Technical Operations Lead, Setup/Teardown crews

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

SAFETY & LOGISTICS

Venue Setup Crew

POSITION SUMMARY Transforms the venue into a safe, organized competition environment by installing fields, pits, tables, barriers, signage, power, staging, and support areas according to the approved floor plan.

Primary Responsibilities

- Unload, move, and place competition fields, skills fields, pit tables, chairs, barriers, stanchions, judging furniture, hospitality equipment, and signage as assigned.
- Follow the approved floor plan and maintain required aisles, exits, accessible routes, and emergency clearances.
- Assist with safe power and cable distribution under the direction of technical and venue leads.
- Build or position fields accurately and report missing, damaged, or unstable components before competition testing begins.
- Use carts, ladders, tools, and lifting techniques safely; request help for heavy or awkward items.
- Keep packaging, cases, and unused equipment consolidated so team areas are clean before doors open.
- Complete a final walkthrough with the Safety / Logistics Lead and area owners before release.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Teamwork and physical readiness
- Ability to follow floor plans
- Safe lifting and basic tool use
- Attention to traffic and emergency clearances

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Wear closed-toe shoes and work gloves when appropriate.
- Review the venue floor plan and staging priorities before unloading.
- Do not relocate power, fields, or safety barriers without approval from the responsible lead.

Coordinates With

Safety / Logistics Lead, Technical Operations Lead, Robot Inspection Lead, venue staff, Signage

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

SAFETY & LOGISTICS

Teardown Crew

POSITION SUMMARY Returns the venue to its required condition after the event by safely dismantling, packing, inventorying, and loading competition equipment, signage, pit materials, and event infrastructure.

Primary Responsibilities

- Begin teardown only when the Safety / Logistics Lead releases the applicable area and teams have cleared required spaces.
- Dismantle fields, pits, barriers, tables, signs, staging, and other event infrastructure using the approved packing method.
- Protect scoring and technology systems until technical leads confirm they are ready for disconnect and removal.
- Sort equipment into labeled cases, carts, pallets, or storage groups and help verify quantities before loading.
- Separate damaged or missing components for documentation instead of hiding problems during packing.
- Remove tape, zip ties, temporary signs, trash, and event materials from the venue without damaging surfaces.
- Complete a final sweep with event and venue leadership before the crew is released.

Skills & Preparation

BEST FIT / SKILLS

- Safe lifting and teamwork
- Organized packing and inventory habits
- Ability to work efficiently at the end of a long event
- Respect for venue and equipment

BEFORE THE EVENT / SHIFT

- Know the assigned packing zones, case labels, and loading sequence.
- Use carts and two-person lifts for heavy or awkward equipment.
- Keep emergency routes open until the venue is fully cleared.

Coordinates With

Safety / Logistics Lead, Technology Breakdown, venue staff, area leads

STANDARD: When instructions conflict or an issue is outside this role's authority, stop and escalate to the appropriate lead rather than improvising a new competition process.

THANK YOU

The quality of a Signature Event is created by people who are prepared, consistent, and focused on students. Every role in this manual contributes directly to a fair competition, a professional production, and an experience teams will remember.

SLUGGER SIGNATURE EVENT • LOUISVILLE, KENTUCKY